

Where the Godavari meets the sea amid endless coconut groves

At a Glance

State	Andhra Pradesh
District	Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Konaseema District
Best Time	October – March
Airport	Rajahmundry (~50 km)
Language	Telugu
Famous For	Coconut groves, Godavari delta, backwaters, temples

Overview

Konaseema, fondly called the 'Paradise of Andhra Pradesh', is a lush green delta formed by the distributaries of the mighty Godavari River as it fans out toward the Bay of Bengal. Spanning roughly 2,000 sq km of emerald landscape, it is famous for seemingly endless coconut plantations, paddy fields, tranquil canals, and a rich cultural and culinary heritage.

Often compared to Kerala's backwaters, the serene network of Godavari distributaries here creates a magical ecosystem. Konaseema was officially recognised as a separate district in 2022, a reflection of its unique identity. The region is part of one of Asia's most fertile river deltas and sits at the intersection of spirituality, nature, and tradition.

Top Attractions

Antarvedi Lakshmi Narasimha Swamy Temple

A celebrated pilgrimage site at the sacred confluence of the Godavari River and the Bay of Bengal. The annual Rathotsavam (chariot festival) draws hundreds of thousands of devotees from across Andhra Pradesh, making it one of the grandest festivals in the region.



■ *Antarvedi Lakshmi Narasimha Swamy Temple*

Coringa Wildlife Sanctuary & Hope Island

India's second-largest mangrove forest covering 235 sq km, home to saltwater crocodiles, fishing cats, spotted deer, and a stunning variety of migratory birds arriving from Central Asia and Siberia between October and February.



■ *Coringa Wildlife Sanctuary & Hope Island*

Draksharamam Bhimeswara Temple

One of the five Pancharama Kshetras of Andhra Pradesh, this 10th-century Chalukyan masterpiece dedicated to Lord Shiva is known for intricate stone carvings, ancient inscriptions, and an enormous Shiva linga that draws pilgrims year-round.



■ *Draksharamam Bhimeswara Temple*

Godavari Backwater Cruise

Board a traditional houseboat or a country boat from Amalapuram or Narsapur for a lazy canal cruise past fishing villages, coconut groves, and lotus ponds — the definitive Konaseema experience that you simply cannot skip.



■ *Godavari Backwater Cruise*

Atreyapuram — The Sweet Village

This small town is the birthplace of Pootharekulu, a unique wafer-thin rice paper sweet stuffed with sugar and ghee. Watch artisans make this fragile delicacy by hand in small cottage workshops — an extraordinary culinary heritage unique to the world.



■ *Atreyapuram — The Sweet Village*

Local Cuisine & Flavours

- Konaseema Kodi Kura — fiery chicken curry with coconut, poppy seeds & green chillies
- Rawanafry — crispy Godavari prawn fry with ginger-garlic and red chilli
- Pootharekulu — ultra-thin rice-paper sweet from Atreyapuram, a GI-tagged delicacy
- Bobbatlu (Puran Poli) — sweet flatbread stuffed with lentil & jaggery, made during festivals
- Chepala Pulusu — tangy tamarind fish curry slow-cooked with onions, the soul of Konaseema cooking

How to Get There

- By Air: Rajahmundry Airport (~50 km) has flights from Hyderabad, Chennai & Bengaluru.
- By Train: Amalapuram Road station connects to Rajahmundry, Kakinada, Vijayawada.
- By Road: NH 216 connects Amalapuram to Rajahmundry (~2 hrs) and Kakinada (~1 hr).
- By Boat: Scenic ferry services crisscross the delta between villages and towns.

Insider Travel Tips

- Hire a local guide for backwater boat tours — they know the best hidden waterways.
- Visit Dec–January for winter migratory birds at Coringa Wildlife Sanctuary.
- Pootharekulu from Atreyapuram make the best souvenirs; buy fresh from artisan homes.
- Wear light cotton; delta humidity is intense from May to September.
- The Draksharamam temple is crowded on Mondays and during Maha Shivaratri — arrive early.

*We hope this guide inspires your journey to **Konaseema**. Travel responsibly, respect local traditions, and leave only footprints.*